NAPROXEN

Lower CV risk among NSAIDs

Take with food

CHEMICAL NAME (S)-2-(6-methoxynaphthalen-2-yl)propanoic acid
CLASS Non-selective NSAID (propionic acid derivative)
TRADE NAMES Naprosyn · Aleve · Naprogesic

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Rheumatoid arthritis, osteoarthritis, ankylosing spondylitis.
- Acute gout.
- Dysmenorrhoea, musculoskeletal pain.
- Migraine (acute treatment).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** with or after food; enteric-coated tablets swallowed whole.
- Twice-daily dosing due to long half-life.

DOSAGES

- **Arthritis:** 500 mg–1 g/day in 1–2 doses.
- **Acute gout:** 750 mg, then 250 mg every 8 h until attack passes.
- **Pain/dysmenorrhoea:** 500 mg, then 250 mg every 6–8 h; max 1.25 g on day 1, then 1 g/day.
- **Children (>5 yr, JIA):** 5 mg/kg twice daily.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1 h. **Peak:** 2–4 h. **Duration:** up to 12 h.
- Highly protein-bound; metabolised in liver.
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** 12–17 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Reversible inhibition of **COX-1 and COX-2** → ↓ prostaglandins.
- Analgesic, anti-inflammatory, antipyretic; long action allows twice-daily dosing.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Dyspepsia, heartburn, nausea.
- Headache, drowsiness, tinnitus.
- Fluid retention.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- GI bleeding and perforation.
- Renal impairment; hyperkalaemia.
- Cardiovascular events (lowest among NSAIDs but still present).
- Bronchospasm; severe skin reactions.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Active peptic ulcer or GI bleeding.
- Severe heart, renal or liver failure.
- NSAID-induced asthma or urticaria.
- Third trimester of pregnancy.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Warfarin, SSRIs, steroids:** ↑ bleeding.
- **Antihypertensives, diuretics:** ↓ effect.
- **Lithium, methotrexate:** ↑ levels.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Check history of ulcers, asthma and renal disease.
- Give with food; consider PPI in high-risk patients.
- Monitor for GI bleeding, oedema and BP.
- Long-term: renal function and CBC.
- Evaluate joint pain, swelling and mobility.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with food and a full glass of water.
- Report black stools, abdominal pain or swelling.
- Avoid other NSAIDs and alcohol.
- May cause drowsiness; take care when driving.

KEY POINTS

- Long-acting NSAID — twice daily.
- Used in gout attacks and arthritis.
- Preferred NSAID when CV risk is a concern.
- Same GI and renal risks as other NSAIDs.

SOURCES CHECKED **[9]** Naproxen 250 mg Tablets (UK SmPC) **[10]** Naproxen, oral (US label) **[11]** Naproxen, oral (US label, Bryant Ranch Prepack) *Full references p. 432–457*